

Judging Criteria

How your project will be judged — use this as your build checklist.

5 July 2026 · Kigali, Rwanda · Teams of 2–5 · Built with Cursor

How your project is scored

These are the exact criteria the judges will use, so treat this as your build checklist. Each of the nine criteria is scored from **1 to 5**, and the criteria are weighted by importance — the ones that matter most are worth the most.

Score	What it means
1 · Emerging	Barely addresses this — not really evident.
2 · Developing	Partly there, with clear gaps.
3 · Solid	Meets the bar — competent and complete.
4 · Strong	Clearly above the bar.
5 · Exceptional	Outstanding — among the very best.

Your score = the sum of (criterion score ÷ 5) × weight, out of 100

Every judge scores you independently, and your final score is the average across the panel. Nothing to fill in here — just build with these in mind.

The one eligibility rule: build it here

You may arrive with an idea, sketches, and generic starter/boilerplate code — but the **substance of your project must be built during the hackathon, using Cursor**.

This is pass / fail. Judges may ask to see your commit history. A project built substantially in advance is disqualified, no matter how good it is. Bring your idea — build it here.

The five challenge tracks

Your project should solve a problem within one of the five official tracks. Your organisers will confirm the exact track names — pick the one your project fits best.

Track	Focus
Digital Public Services & Citizen Experience	Focus on the Society wellness

Track	Focus
Financial Inclusion & Smart Banking	Focus on FinTech
Education & Future Skills	Focus on the Smart and EduTech
SME Growth & Entrepreneurship	Focus on business operation technologies and advancement
Health & Community Wellbeing	Focus on the community wellbeing

What the judges look for

Nine criteria, grouped below with their weights. The description after each is what a top entry looks like — aim there.

Relevance & impact

- **Track Alignment 8** — how squarely you solve a problem in your chosen track. *Aim for: pick one track and solve a real, specific problem in it — don't spread thin.*
- **Rwandan Impact 15** — real, practical value for people or businesses in Rwanda. *Aim for: solve a problem real Rwandans have; be concrete about who benefits and how.*

Solution & execution

- **Functionality 15** — whether it actually works as a live, interactive prototype. *Aim for: a working demo beats slides — make the core flow run end to end.*
- **Technical Depth 13** — the soundness of the engineering behind it. *Aim for: a sensible data model, real integrations, and clean, working code.*
- **User Experience 11** — how intuitive and clean it is to use. *Aim for: make the main task obvious and fast; polish the happy path.*
- **Feasibility 8** — how realistic it is to deploy and scale locally. *Aim for: show it could run in the real world, not just on your laptop.*

Craft & creativity

- **Innovation 11** — the creativity and originality of the idea or approach. *Aim for: bring a fresh angle — a novel idea, or a clever use of familiar tools.*
- **AI Tool Leverage (Cursor) 8** — how well you used Cursor and AI to build. *Aim for: use Cursor to build more than you could by hand — and be ready to show how.*

Communication

→ **The Pitch 11** — how clearly and convincingly you present. *Aim for: lead with the problem and who it helps, show it working, keep it tight.*

Weighting at a glance

Where the points are — the criteria totalling the most are worth focusing on first.

Criterion	Weight
Rwandan Impact	15
Functionality	15
Technical Depth	13
User Experience	11
Innovation	11
The Pitch	11
Track Alignment	8
Feasibility	8
AI Tool Leverage (Cursor)	8
Total	100

On the day: your demo

Each team gets roughly **5 minutes to demo** plus about **3 minutes of Q&A** (your organisers will confirm the exact timing). To make it count:

- Lead with the problem and who it helps — then show your solution.
- Show it **working**: a live demo beats slides every time.
- Keep it tight and leave room for the judges' questions.
- Be ready to show your commit history or walk through the code if asked.

How ties are broken

If two teams tie on final score within a track, the judges look at — in order — average **Rwandan Impact**, then **Functionality**, then **Technical Depth**. Another reason to make those three genuinely strong.

Build something real that helps Rwanda, make it work, and show it clearly. Good luck!